

COMPOSITE INDEX OF GENDER INEQUALITY BY INDIAN STATES ON YOUNG WOMEN BASED ON UNPAID LABOUR, POLITICAL REPRESENTATION AND WORKFORCE PARTICIPATION

ODDHOUSE REPORT

k. Evan Tejas

Goals

- Measure the gender inequality in different Indian states using multiple indices.
- Create a composite index
- Understand min-max normalisation

Data methodology

Process

The data used in this report targets women and men of age 15 to 29 as this is a critical years in their youth. The general procedure consists of taking a ratio of women and men.

$$R_i = \frac{I_{\text{women}}}{I_{\text{men}}}$$

This ratio is then scaled to fit between 0 and 1 to give a uniform score using min max normalization, which can be compared between multiple indices. For example the ratio of women workforce participation would look like:

$$I_n = \frac{R_i - R_{\min}}{R_{\max} - R_{\min}}$$

This index would give higher score to higher ratio. In case of unpaid labour higher score shows more work done by women then men, meaning this state has higher inequality. For political representation and workforce participation higher score means there is higher equality.

This report tried to rank states with highest inequality thus a higher score must mean most unequal. Due to this, I_n must be flipped for political and workforce indices.

For example, the workforce index:

$$I_n \text{ final workforce} = 1 - I_n \text{ workforce}$$

After this crucial step, higher score would always mean higher inequality.

To create to composite index all the indices are taken with equal weights:

$$I_n \text{ final} = \frac{I_p + I_w + I_u}{3}$$

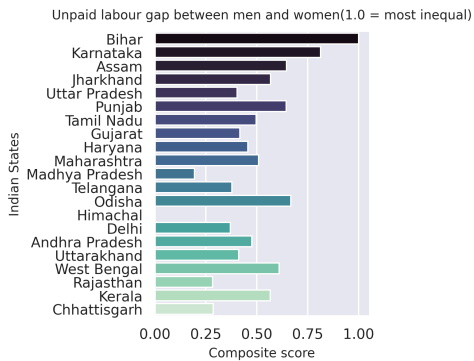
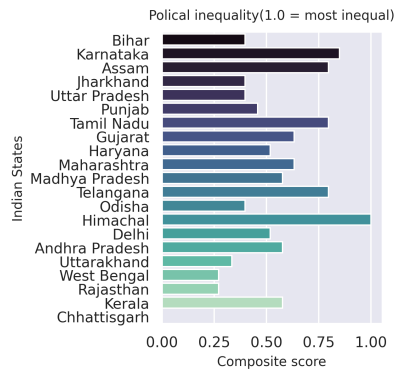
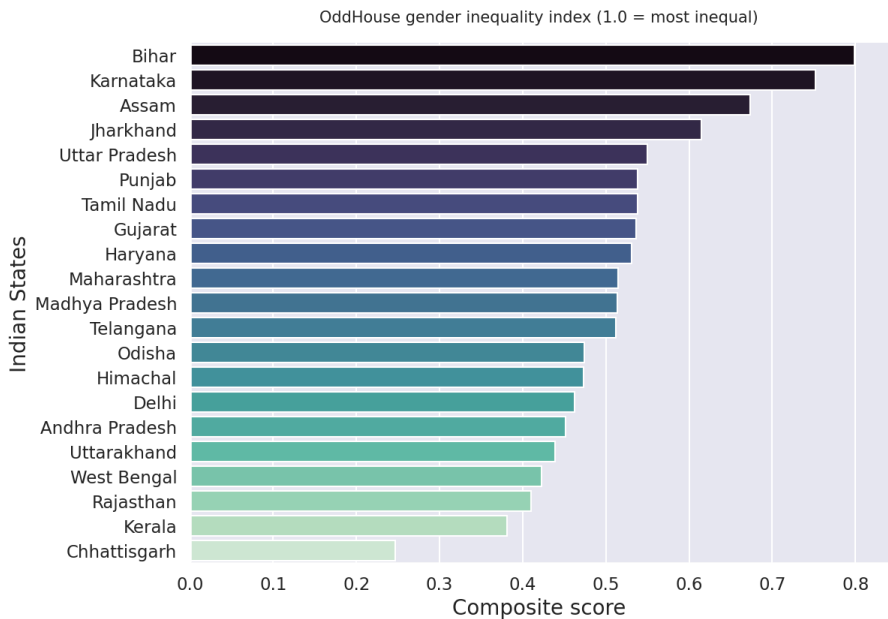
where p = political representation, w = workforce participation, u = unpaid labour.

Why we do the way we do?

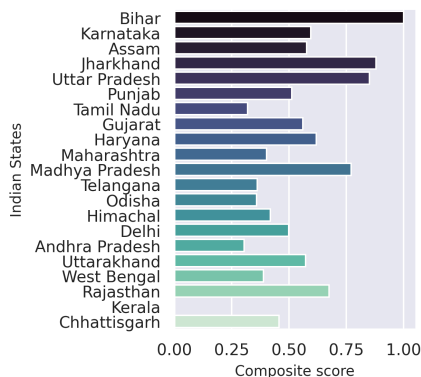
Inequality in terms of freedom and responsibilities is our aim. This report tries to measure the underlying social fabric. This shows how much more women work than men relative to each other. The age group selected is 15 to 29 this is the age when they step into adulthood. Finally all three of these index are weighed equally as there is not any proper weights between these dimensions, Different people have different opinions on which dimension has more importance, like HDI this study too uses equal weighting to exclude subjective bias from the sub indices and keep them transparent while acting as a proxy even if they are not the best fit.

Findings

Rankings



Workforce participation gap between men and women (1.0 = most unequal)



Analysis

From the composite index the following graph was plotted. Bihar was the state with highest gender inequality while chhattisgarh has the least but not zero.

- Bihar had the highest inequality for unpaid labour and workforce participation, this may suggest that while Bihar had good political representation it does not translate to good opportunities for young women.
- Karnataka is second on the list and scores closer to one on all the indices, the same could be said for Assam and Jharkhand; raising its score and ranking higher on the index.
- Himachal has the highest political inequality however it has low-moderate inequality in terms of workforce participation and unpaid labour.
- Chhattisgarh is the most equal state gender wise, having the most equal of indian state in political participation.

Conclusions

This rankings based on workforce participation, unpaid labour gap and political participation of women aims to measure gender equality in India while trying to use measures which are not affected by wealth of the states to give a unfiltered answer.

It shall be noted that these states often face two types of inequality; political and physical. Bihar's legislature has good amount of women present but this representation had no effect on physical parts of life. It can be argued that not all types of political representation provides equal opportunities,

which can be seen in Bihar. Meanwhile, chattisgarh had the most amount of women participation in politics and ranked the lowest. This study's aim is not to find correlation between equality and political representation, as it can be seen with himachal with the highest inequality in politics and yet having a lower score than most other states. From this, we notice that political representation in Bihar is flawed. Either women are merely for show i.e proxy candidates, and are controlled by men or they are not taking decisions in the best interest of women.

States like Assam and karnataka have all round high inequality, which is shocking considering that karnataka has good all round development. These states demand a different type of policies to help the women. High amount of women from these states are working in unpaid labour and are absent in paid work. Karnataka can be explained from the fact that karnataka is mostly developed only in a single city, the data from the entire state skews this. Rural infrastructure maybe lacking or women face problems from family laws or social constraints. Then, a wider population of karnataka must be supported to increase the equality in the state.

Limitations

- Political participation data was from 2023 before reservation of seats for women which sits at a different time compared to PLFS and TUS data. While proper timeline is important, proper
- few states were dropped as they lacked the data to conduct this analysis;

Arunachal Pradesh	Goa
Manipur	Meghalaya
Mizoram	Nagaland
Sikkim	Tripura

Data

Political represntation -

prsindia.org 2023

unpaid labour -

TUS 2019

workforce participation-

PLFS 2019